# HARSHAL ZALKE

hzalke@princeton.edu | harshalzalke.github.io

## ACADEMIC APPOINTMENTS

**Vanderbilt University** 2026-27
*Postdoctoral Scholar*, Department of Political Science

## EDUCATION

**Princeton University** 2026
*PhD*, Department of Politics
Fields:*Political Economy, Formal Theory and Quantitative Methods, International Relations*
Committee Members: *Kris Ramsay (Chair), Mehdi Shadmehr, Germán Gieczewski*

**The University of Texas at Austin** 2020
*M.A.*, LBJ School of Public Affairs

**The University of Texas at Austin** 2018
*M.S.*, Department of Operations Research and Industrial Engineering

**Visvesvaraya National Institute of Technology, India** 2014
*B.Tech.*, Mechanical Engineering

## WORKING PAPERS

- **"Coordinating Development Under Political Risk"**
(with Mehdi Shadmehr)
  - *Under Review*
- **"Security Risks and the Screening of Investments"**
*(Job Market Paper)*
  - *Presentations: Stanford GSB PE Seminar 2026, APSA 2026, MPSA 2026*
- **"Dynamic Screening with Hidden Harm"**
*(Dissertation Chapter)*
- **"The Geopolitics of Investment Screening: How Interstate Rivalry Shapes Market Access"**
*(Dissertation Chapter)*
- **"Strategic Investments and War Prevention"**
  - *Presentations: MPSA 2025, APSA 2024, GSIPE 2024*

## SELECTED WORKS IN PROGRESS

- **"The Value of Intelligence in Conflict"**
*(with Kris Ramsay)*
  - *APSA 2026, MPSA 2026*
- **"Optimal Sanctions Regime"**

## INVITED TALKS AND CONFERENCES

- Stanford GSB PE Seminar 2026
- American Political Science Association 2020, 2024, 2025, 2026

- Midwest Political Science Association 2024, 2025, 2026
- Graduate Students in International Political Economy Workshop 2024
- The Politics and Regulation of Investment Screening Mechanisms 2022

## TEACHING EXPERIENCE

At Princeton:

- **POL 345: Introduction to Quantitative Social Science (U)**, (TA for Arthur Yu) Fall 2025
- **POL 396: International Organization (U)**, (TA for Jim Vreeland) Spring 2024
- **POL 572: Quantitative Analysis 1 (G)**, (TA for Rocio Titiunik) Spring 2023
- **POL 573: Quantitative Analysis 2 (G)**, (TA for Rocio Titiunik) Fall 2023

At UT Austin:

- **FIN 357: Business Finance (U)**, (TA for Robert Duvic) 2018 - 2020
- **STA 380: Mathematical Statistics for Applications (G)**, (TA for Thomas Sager) Fall 2017
- **PHY 103M: Laboratory for Physics (U)**, Spring 2017

## RESEARCH EXPERIENCE

- Research Assistant for Helen Milner, *Princeton University* Summer 2022
- Research Assistant for Layna Mosley, *Princeton University* Spring 2021
- Research Assistant for Catherine Weaver, *The University of Texas at Austin* 2019 - 2020

## PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

- Summer Intern, *Carnegie Council for Ethics in International Affairs* Summer 2019
- Sr. Engineer (Supply Chain), *Bajaj Auto Ltd* 2014 - 2016

## FELLOWSHIPS AND HONORS

- Dean's Completion Fellowship, *Princeton University* 2025-2026
- The John Fayerweather '43 Graduate Fellowship, *Princeton University* 2023-2024
- Quantitative and Analytical Political Science Fellow, *Princeton University* 2022-2026
- Niehaus Center for Globalization and Governance, *Princeton University* 2020-2021
- Lyndon Baines Johnson Foundation Fellowship, *UT Austin* Spring 2019
- Charls and Harmolyn Walker Public Policy Excellence Fund Fellowship, *UT Austin* Summer 2019

## REFERENCES

- **Kristopher Ramsay**
  Professor
  Department of Politics, Princeton University
  003 Fisher Hall
  609-258-2960
  kramsay@princeton.edu

- **Mehdi Shadmehr**
  Associate Professor
  Department of Public Policy, UNC Chapel Hill
  mshadmeh@gmail.com

- **Germán Gieczewski**
  Associate Professor
  Department of Politics, Princeton University
  311 Fisher Hall
  (609) 258-9933
  germang@princeton.edu